

# Ellie (Gaeun) Choi

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F-1 Visa | STEM-OPT eligible — authorized to work up to 3 years without sponsorship

## EDUCATION

### M.S. in Finance (MSF) + Graduate Certificate in FinTech

Jan 2027 – Exp. Dec 2028

University of Utah, David Eccles School of Business | Salt Lake City, UT

### B.S. in Information Systems

Exp. Dec 2026

University of Utah, David Eccles School of Business | Salt Lake City, UT

- Minors: Business Analytics and Urban Ecology & Planning
- Relevant coursework: Blockchain for Business, Cloud Computing, Visual Analytics, GIS for Urban Ecologists

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Finance & Analytics:** Financial reconciliation, budgeting & reporting, Excel modeling, SQL/MySQL, Python (pandas, scikit-learn, nltk), Tableau, Power BI

**NLP & Machine Learning:** FinBERT, VADER, Random Forest, LightGBM, XGBoost, Twitter API, Yahoo Finance API

**Spatial & Tools:** ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, GitHub, HTML/CSS, Java, Adobe Creative Suite, Figma, Google Workspace

## RESEARCH

### Predicting Stock Price Movements Using Market Data and Investor Sentiment

2026

Co-Author | Faculty Mentors: Emre Ertan, Chong Oh | David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah

- Tested the weak-form Efficient Market Hypothesis using S&P 500 price data and FinBERT sentiment extracted from financial news headlines.
- Trained and compared Random Forest, LightGBM, and XGBoost with and without sentiment features; sentiment improved accuracy and reduced false positives, providing evidence against weak-form EMH.

### A Multidimensional Framework for Winning Super Bowl Advertising

2026

First Author | Faculty Advisor: Chong Oh | David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah

- Analyzed 64,230 tweets from 59 Super Bowl LX brands; engineered 6 metrics including ROI Efficiency (\$8M cost baseline), Engagement Efficiency, and Sustained Ratio into a composite Winning Score Model.
- Found  $R^2 < 0.05$  between Ad Meter rankings and Winning Score, showing that high visibility does not equal positive reception.

## RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

### Student Finance Operations Assistant

2026 – Present

College of Architecture & Planning, University of Utah | Salt Lake City, UT

- Process and reconcile student finance transactions and operational records, maintaining data integrity across budgeting and reporting workflows.
- Apply accounting fundamentals to flag and resolve discrepancies, supporting accurate financial reporting for the college.

### Teaching Assistant — Information Systems

Aug 2025 – Present

David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah | Salt Lake City, UT

- Support IS 2010 (Spreadsheet Analysis) and IS 3060 serving 100+ students through labs, grading, and 1-on-1 Excel financial modeling guidance.
- Selected as TA for the 2025 Adobe Social Impact Challenge, advising teams and providing structured feedback.

### Lead Peer Advisor

Feb 2024 – Dec 2024

University of Utah Asia Campus | Incheon, South Korea

- Coordinated peer advising activities, mentored junior advisors, and provided academic guidance to 30+ business students per semester.

## SELECTED PROJECTS

### Where Should You Invest in Salt Lake City? — GIS Investment Screening

Summer 2026

CMP 4450: GIS for Urban Ecologists | University of Utah

- Scored all 2,711 SLC residential zones on a 0–3 composite index combining school, park, and TRAX transit access using ArcGIS Pro and five public UGRC datasets.
- Identified 713 full-access zones (26.3%) and flagged transit as the primary bottleneck; translated results into investment stability and upside signals.

## LEADERSHIP & AWARDS

- Executive Director, International Students in Business Club; VP, Accounting Club and TEK (IS) Club (2023–Present).
- 1st Place, UAC Adobe Social Impact Challenge (Spring 2023) | New Horizon Scholarship, \$2,000/yr. | Salesforce-Eccles Ideathon participant (Sep 2025).
- Music Director, short film "HELLPER" — Official Selection, Bucheon International Fantastic Film Festival (BIFAN) | Languages: Korean (Native), English (Professional Working Proficiency).